

SEBASTIAN OLASCOAGA

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2018–2023

Ph.D. in Urban Economics and Policy

Honors: MIT Presidential (2018–2019) and Departmental (2019–2023) Fellowships

Paris School of Economics (PSE) 2013–2015

Master of Science in Applied Economics

Honors: Graduated *Summa Cum Laude*

Centro de Investigación y Docencia Económicas (CIDE) 2008–2012

Bachelor's in Economics

Honors: Highest national score on the mandatory economics exit examination (CENEVAL).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

City of Boston 2024 - Present

Director of Evaluation (2024 – Present) and Evaluation and Research Lead (2023 – 2024)

- Established an evaluation unit to conduct impact evaluations of city programs and services that now inform the creation of new policies.
- Designed systems to embed evidence-based decision-making into the city's budget process. Our unit is now involved in helping the Mayor and its Finance team decide about new and existing programs and projects.
- Developed our predictive and causal research unit, enabling cross-departmental collaboration to predict rodent appearances, undisclosed rental unit registrations, and parking routes, etc.

Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2025 - Present

Lecturer

- Teach graduate-level microeconomics with applications to urban and regional policy, equipping students with skills to analyze housing markets, land use, and transportation systems.
- Developed coursework blending economic theory with practical applications, focusing on real estate economics, city distribution, and public policy interventions.

Redfin 2021 – 2022

Economist Fellow

- Conducted two randomized controlled trials to understand how extreme weather risk scores influence user behavior and bidding patterns, leading to multiple Redfin media mentions and an NBER publication.

- Published findings in academic and industry channels, contributing to Redfin's first formal academic-industry partnership and increasing visibility on the relationship between climate, migration, health, and housing.

OptumLabs

2019 – 2021

Health Economist Visiting Fellow

- Applied causal analysis to billions of claims and health records, which led to a publication in JAMA Network Open and was covered by the national media (MIT News, NPR Marketplace) and influencing state-level rental assistance policies.

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2019 and 2022

Head Teaching Assistant - Quantitative Reasoning

- Led a team of 5 teaching assistants, maintaining the highest student rating (7/7) in the course's history. Facilitated coursework and workshops to strengthen graduate students' proficiency in statistical methods, data analysis, and policy evaluation techniques.

Treasury Department (Mexico)

2015–2018

Director of Economic Policy

- Led research to forecast economic scenarios and fiscal measures, resulting in Mexico's first fiscal surplus in nine years and a reduced debt-to-GDP ratio.
- Presented multiple times economic risk assessments to Mexico's Financial Stability Oversight Council, influencing national fiscal policy and mitigating market instability.
- Supported NAFTA renegotiations by providing economic impact analyses, aligning policy objectives across Mexico, the US, and Canada.

Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD)

2014–2015

Junior Researcher – Directorate for Employment, Labor and Social Affairs

- Supported cross-national analyses on labor market trends and policy effectiveness, contributing to OECD reports on employment and income inequality.
- Conducted statistical modeling to evaluate workforce participation and its relationship with social programs, providing data-driven recommendations to member countries.

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA)

2014

Research Consultant

Universidad Iberoamericana

2012 - 2013

Research Assistant

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

- Sandoval Olascoaga, S., Shu, E., & Porter, J. (2025). Flood risk and property value changes: understanding the impact of climate event exposure in the context of population change. *Frontiers in Environmental Economics*, 4, 1615802.
- Fairweather, D., Kahn, M. E., Metcalfe, R. D., & Olascoaga, S. S. (2024). Expecting Climate Change: A Nationwide Field Experiment in the Housing Market (No. w33119). National Bureau of Economic Research. ***Revise and Resubmit, American Economic Review***
- Shu, E. G., Porter, J. R., Hauer, M. E., Sandoval Olascoaga, S., Gourevitch, J., Wilson, B., ... & Kearns, E. (2023). Integrating climate change induced flood risk into future population projections. *Nature Communications*, 14(1), 7870.
- Sandoval-Olascoaga, S., Garcia, C., Zayas, G., Arcaya, M. (2024). Housing Conditions in the COVID-19 Pandemic. In book: *The Social Epidemiology of the COVID-19 Pandemic*. Publisher: Oxford University Press. Editors: Duncan, D., Kawachi, I., Morse, S.
- Sandoval-Olascoaga, S., Venkataramani A., Arcaya, M. (2021). Eviction Moratoria Expiration and COVID-19 Infection Risk Across Strata of Health and Socioeconomic Status in the United States. In: *JAMA Network Open*, 4(8):e2129041.
- Vilar, M., Sandoval-Olascoaga, S., Bernal, A., Shimoga, S., Bustamante, A. (2015). The impact of the 2008 financial crisis on food security and food expenditures in Mexico: a disproportionate effect on the vulnerable. In: *Public Health Nutrition*, Cambridge University Press.
- Vilar, M., Sandoval-Olascoaga, S., Bernal, A., Perez, A. (2014). The Effect of Mexican Household Food Security Status and Income Distribution on Food Access. In: *Food Studies: An Interdisciplinary Journal*, Volume 3, Issue 2.
- Vilar, M., Sandoval-Olascoaga, S., Bernal, A., Perez, A. (2014). Mexico: A complex mosaic of population nutrition problems. In book: *Pobreza y Desigualdad: un enfoque multidisciplinario*. Publisher: Universidad Iberoamericana. Editor: Pablo Cotler.

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Stakeholder Advisory Board - Harvard Chan School of Public Health, *NIEHS Center for Environmental Health* (2024 – Present)
- MIT *Presidential* and *Departmental* Fellowship (2018–2023).
 - *Presidential* Fellowship is awarded to ~10% of MIT entering graduate students annually.
- First Street Foundation Fellow (2022 - 2024).

- Harold Horowitz Research (MIT) Fund (2022).
- CONACYT Graduate Fellowship (2018–2022).
- OptumLabs Fellow (2019 – 2021).
- Priscilla King Gray (MIT) Fellow (Summer 2021).
- Boston Area Research Initiative (Northeastern and Harvard University) Research Seed Grant (2020–2021).
- Priscilla King Gray (MIT) Fellow. (Winter 2020).
- Lloyd and Nadine Rodwin International Fellowship (2018).
- Graduated *Summa Cum Laude* from my Master’s degree (2015).
- CONACYT Graduate Fellowship (2015).
- Agence Française de Développement (AFD) Fellowship (2013–2015).
- CENEVAL award for getting the Top National Score for the Economics Exit Examination (2012).
- Emerging Leaders in the Americas Program (ELAP) Canadian scholarship (2011).
- Center for Research and Teaching of Economics (CIDE) Fellowship (2008–2012).

ACADEMIC AND COMMUNITY SERVICE

- Referee for the Journal of Development Economics, Health Affairs, Latin American Economic Review, ClinicoEconomics and Outcomes Research, Health and Place, and Habitat International.
- Ph.D. Admission Committee Member for MIT’s Environmental Policy and Planning Ph.D. Track (2020, 2021, 2022).
- Member of MIT’s Graduate Student Council (2020–2022)
- Member MIT’s Graduate Housing Working Group Subcommittee (2020–2022).
- Member of MIT’s Graduate Student Council Advocacy Subcommittee (2020–2022).
- Board Member of the Paris School of Economics Students’ Association (2013–2015).

SKILLS

- *Programming and Statistical Languages:* R, STATA, Python, QGIS, SQL, AWS (S3 and Redshift), and Git.
- *Languages:* English, Spanish, and French.